

OUR VISION

- Local People's participation
- Their empowerment in decision making
- People's control over Resources

In order to find solutions to environmental degradation and make it a better place to live in. We also strive for sustainable development.



NEWSLETTER

NOVEMBER 2009

Our Mission

Janhit Foundation envisions to work towards a pollution free world where every individual can have a healthy existence and promotes sustainable development in every sphere. Through its local and national initiatives Janhit Foundation links up to global initiatives and believes in creating positive global impacts.



Janhit Foundation is an independent non-governmental civil society organisation, actively engaged in the promotion of human welfare through environmental protection and education since 1998.

Our key areas of work include:

- Groundwater quality protection for human health
- Protection of river water quality for both aquatic ecosystems and human health
- Provision of safe drinking water to marginalised communities
- Enhancement of available water resources through water conservation measures
- Promotion of sustainable agricultural systems through organic farming
- Environmental education and empowerment for local communities
- Academic and cultural education for children in marginalised communities
- Protecting the human rights of children
- Livelihood opportunities for members of marginalised communities
- Household income enhancement for marginalised communities.

Janhit Foundation undertakes this work through a variety of methods including scientific research, awareness campaigns and lobbying and advocacy. At the heart of Janhit Foundations work is grass-roots level community involvement and participation with the aim of empowerment and betterment of our society. Janhit Foundation focuses on strengthen communities through their active participation in decision making and project implementation to achieve sustainable development. We believe that degradation and poverty can only be addressed adequately if local people including the most marginalised members of our community are empowered in decision making at all levels and have control over resources.

To achieve our goals we work in partnership with state and national government, nongovernmental, national and international organisations on issues affecting the environment, human rights and poverty.



Geographical Scope of The Organisation

Uttar Pradesh



The Janhit Foundation is working in the Indo-Gangetic alluvial fed states of India, i.e. in Western Uttar Pradesh, Punjab and Haryana. Its Area of focus in Uttar Pradesh is primarily Meerut, Baghpat, Ghaziabad and Muzaffarnagar.

- From the Director's Desk

Firstly, My Diwali Greetings to all the Readers. I hope you had a happy and enjoyable Diwali. Secondly I would like to announce that Janhit is launching two new projects this month, 'Water Literacy on Wheels' and 'My Clean Meerut'. With these new projects I am confident our team will bring a positive spark to the society for the much needed change to our environment and well being.

Beneficiaries at Various Stages

Since its establishment the organisation has been able to make a difference to many a lives...

- Farmers by motivating them to practice organic farming which is proving to be a better farming practice, bringing economic and general prosperity in their lives.
- Students by providing them guidance with their PHDs, research papers, exchange programs, internships and also through information dissemination and awareness.
- Teachers and Lecturers through presentations, documentary film shows, lectures and discussions given in a number of schools, colleges, universities and research institutes.

- Researchers by providing them data and other material relevant to their studies, practical trainings etc.

Also scientists, government departments, various stakeholders, other NGOs, national and international organisations and even the common people have been influenced by us in more than one way.

As a public interest organisation, Janhit Foundation works with the marginalized communities, women and minorities. It is the belief of the organisation that environmental degradation can only be addressed adequately if local people are empowered in decision making at all levels and have control over resources.

Contact Details

Janhit Foundation
180/7 Shastri Nagar,
Meerut, Uttar Pradesh
India

Ph: +91-121-2763418/4004123
Fax : +91-121-2763418
janhitfoundation@gmail.com
www.janhitfoundation.in



The Universal Right: Access to Clean Water

- Aditi Sheth, II Semester, Gujarat National Law University

It is common knowledge that water is essential for life. Thus, the right to clean, drinking water emanates from the Right to Life under Article 21 of the Indian Constitution.

This has been reiterated by courts in India in a number of judgments, including *FK Hussain v. Union of India* (The Court's opinion was that an administrative agency could not be permitted to function in such a manner as to make inroads into the fundamental right guaranteed under Article 21 of the Constitution. The right to sweet water and the right to free air are the attributes of the right to life. They are the basic elements that sustain life), *M.C. Mehta v. Union of India* (Groundwater is a social asset, and the right of the citizen to the use of water, air and earth are protected under Article 21 of the Constitution. It further states that the environmental balance should be maintained and wherever groundwater is required for domestic and agriculture needs, priority is to be given to these), and *Vellore Citizens' Welfare Forum v. Union of India* ((1996) 5 SCC 647 It was held: "The constitutional and statutory provisions protect a person's right to fresh air, clean water and pollution-free environment, but the source of the right is the inalienable common law right of clean environment") among others, some of which are mentioned below.

It has been held in *Narmada Bachao Andolan v. Union of India* ((2000) 10 SCC 664 In the judgment Kirpal, J. observed that: "Water is the basic need

for the survival of human beings and is part of the right to life and human rights as enshrined in Article 21 of the Constitution of India....") that the rights to healthy environment and to sustainable development are fundamental human rights implicit in the right to "life".

Right to water can be further inferred from Article 15(2) of the Constitution which states that no citizen shall be subjected to any limitation with regard to the use of wells, tanks, bathing ghats.

Moreover, as per the resolution in the United Nations Water Conference in 1977, "All people, whatever their stage of development and their social and economic conditions, have the right to have access to drinking water in quantum and of a quality equal to their basic needs." Referring to India's participation in the Conference the Court held in *A.P. Pollution Control Board II v. Prof. M.V. Nayudu* ((2001) 2 SCC 62 The court held that drinking water is of primary importance in any country), that the right to access to drinking water is fundamental to life and there is a duty on the State under Article 21 to provide clean drinking water to its citizens.

Concluding, though the Right to Water has not been explicitly mentioned in the Indian Constitution, it has been held to be included in the wide ambit of Article 21, and should thus be enforced for the sake of the teeming millions who have been deprived of such a basic need.

For this newsletter Janhit Foundation invited Students to write an article regarding any of our key areas of work, the best articles would then be published in this month's newsletter. We would like to take this opportunity to thank all those students who wrote articles and congratulate them all.

Back To Basics

- Rakesh Singh, Vith Semester, Chanakya National Law University, Patna

Organic farming may sound new and scientific invention of a new kind of farming, but as a matter of fact, this is the same old method of farming which was once used by our forefathers.

This is a kind of farming where there is no use of any chemical; be it seed, fertilizer or any product which is used to raise the production. The very purpose of use of chemicals was increase in the yield and also it was believed that there is less chances of crop failure. Also, since the production was raised manifolds in the beginning, so it was believed that it is economical too.

Now, after a long and reckless use of chemical farming, we are facing the consequences. The consequences are in various forms, such as one of the biggest consequences is farmers' suicide, due to non-payment of loans which they take from banks in order to procure high quality seeds and fertilizers which are costly too.

Organic farming is such a process where there is less demand of capital for the pre-production works. It involves preparation of compost, bio-fertilizer, crop rotation and cover crop. Although

the yield is not much as compared to when achieved by the use of chemical fertilizer, but as per rules of economics in the method of organic farming there is less involvement of money which makes it more economical, also the liability of paying back the money which depends on the market rate, even if there is enough production and a farmer is unable to get the required price is major concern for any farmer.

The most important outcome of organic farming is maintenance of balance of soil nutrition which is very essential for the farmers in India and will prove helpful in long run.





Highlights of Last Few Months

Independence Day Celebrations

Children from the Gyan Ashram's as well as Meerut Childline Staff marked the 62nd Indian Independence day with a programme on the 14th of August 2009. The event was held at Janhit Foundation's office and was attended by the whole team and local people as well as the local press. The celebrations were started in a very traditionally with the lightening of the lamp and Saraswati Vandana which was then followed by the patriotic song competition, dance competition and poem competition and the all slum children actively participated in these. Also during this event, there was a flag hoisting ceremony to mark the moment of Independence. At the end, Sweets were distributed among all the children. The drawing competition was won by Sonali, Priyanka, Tamanna, the dance competition was won by Poonam, Rinky and Sangeeta. The poem competition was won by Priyanka, Sonu and Anjali. They were awarded prizes for the same on 27th August in a public function.



Doctors Conference on Organic Food

A seminar was organised by Janhit Foundation, for the Physicians of Meerut to discuss the advantages of Organically Grown food and was held on Sunday, 30th August 2009. The topic of discussion was 'Organic Food v/s chemically grown Food'. Physicians favoured the organic food as it protects and conserves the environment, and helps to decrease the pollution in water. Organic farming should be followed and promoted as it is Less Water intensive; it restores soil nutrients, has minimal input cost, gives higher premiums for farmers and is environment friendly. They preferred organic farming as it is Sustainable Form of Agriculture. It is better for human health, as it is high in nutrients and is tastier. Also, it is high on antioxidants, conserves and promotes bio-diversity; it is less water intensive, hence more viable for farmers. It is in harmonious with nature, nurtures and protects wildlife, and also



reduces potential health risks caused by the use of chemicals in the local environment.

Janhit relies upon crop rotations, crop residue, animal manures, off farm organic wastes, mechanical cultivation mineral bearing rocks, and aspects of biological pest control to maintain soil productivity and to supply plant nutrients, and to control insects, weeds and other pests.

Launch of the CAF project

September saw the launch of the latest Janhit Foundation's project, "Spreading Water Literacy on Wheels" in association with CAF India and Adobe Systems India Private Limited. This new project aims to spread the importance of water quality and conservation to the youth in Noida and Ghaziabad. Through a series of workshops and informative lessons, staff will teach children about the importance of water to Indian society, the threats to our water security, water quality and its importance, how it is measured as well as water conservation and rainwater harvesting techniques. Demonstrations and other activities will be carried out from a mobile unit. As part of the project the foundation purchased a Tata Winger which they will design and convert for the purpose of traveling around the schools in both Noida and Ghaziabad. Keep a look out for the van which will be hitting the streets in the near future.



Fair In Delhi

Janhit Foundation had participated in the MTNL Health Mela which was organised by the Delhi Government from October 3rd to October 12th, 2009 in Delhi with an objective to create mass health awareness. The foundation had erected a stall at the Mela where it displayed its organic products along with our numerous



publications. Working models of organic manures such as NADEP, Vermiwash and Vermi Compost were also displayed so that the visitors can understand the processes and inputs used in organic cultivation.

The organisation successfully sold Rs. 22,500.00 worth of its in house publications literature and organic products such as Wheat Flour, Pulses, Mustard Oil, Honey, Rice, Besan etc. The visitors were attracted by the reasonable prices (organic products available to them in Delhi are

expensive) and the well informed staff who were aptly able to explain to them any information they required. Most felt Janhit's products are inexpensive compared to the products available in Delhi and wanted to be regular customers. The foundation was also approached by some buyers who are interested in buying products in bulk quantity.

The mela was a success for all and also proved to be a good platform for Janhit Foundation to strengthen its market linkages which in turn would further strengthen the organic movement which the organization is spreading in the area.

Janhit Foundation is especially thankful to Mr. Prabhjot Sodhi ji for his guidance and help in letting us know about the Mela and also in helping us setup our stall.



Janhit Brings Additional Income to its Farmers alongwith Sugarcane Cultivation

Here farmers are monotonous about only growing sugarcane in their fields. The Janhit team made them aware of how to adapt to inter cropping which would help them in many ways. We also conducted a case study which demonstrated through the results that very few farmers were aware of the process of inter cropping with turmeric and its benefits.

For 1 Acre :

Seed = 1 quintal @ 1,200 per quintal = 12,000.00

Production = 60 quintal @ 1,000 per quintal = 60,000.00 (If sold as raw)

Inputs are farm based, No pesticides required (as turmeric itself acts as a pesticide).
Water is already available.

Also, it was observed from the case study that if oil is extracted, then for the same crop it is 3-5% of the total crop. In 60 Quintals of turmeric we can get 180 litre oil per acre and additional income of @ Rs. 300/- per litre i.e. Rs. 54000/- in ten months.

The team concluded that after this round of cultivation and harvest, farmers can also grow moong in remaining two months time and again turmeric in the next year. It maintains the soil fertility. Again a profit of minimum Rs 25000/- @ Rs. 5000/- for each kg 5 kg moong would be obtained. The best part is that if the rate for any of the crop goes down, other income additional is already there. Moreover, turmeric has a good local market here.



Meerut CHILDLINE in Action

During the first fortnight in August, Meerut Child line participated in most of the activities organised with the children from different slum areas. There was an exhibition by slum children named 'Jhanki' which was to make people aware about the problems wild animals face in their struggle for survival. The children enthusiastically participated in this and were eager to show people what they had learnt. A drawing competition for the same children was organised in which the topic was 'Independence day'. Children relished the opportunity to show their artistic skills and came out with flying colours in this activity too.



Then, Meerut Child line took around 50 children to the movie 'Shaheed Bhagat Singh'. The children enjoyed learning about the life of this freedom fighter. Then, there were cultural activities and a prize ceremony for the song, dance and poem competition held on Independence day. On 6th September, 2009, Meerut CHILDLINE organized a Quarterly Computer training Program for orphan children in Bal Sadan. This program is for three months and a teacher will give training to these children on a daily basis. Meerut CHILDLINE provides counseling for all children of Bal Sadan. In this, children speak of their problems and we advise them on how to solve them. Those children from Bal Sadan who go to school will learn a lot from this computer education and it will be very beneficial for them in their future. On 19th September, 2009, Meerut Children cleaned the Slum in the program 'Clean up the World' which was organized by the Hindustan Daily News Paper and planted 15 Neem Trees. Slum Children also participated in the program of the Hindustan Daily Newspapers activities. CHILDLINE Team members gave their knowledge about Neem trees to the people in the Slum. The slum area was cleaned up by the team members and they planted many Neem plants. By this, they inspired people to clean the environment and also told them the advantages of keeping the environment clean. People there asked questions about environment which were answered by our team. On 26th of September, 2009, Meerut CHILDLINE held a Workshop in the city Railway Station. 50 People from the Railway Station staff participated including station Master G.R.P, R.P.F.Coolies, P.C.O. owners, Rickshaw and Tempo Driver children who polish shoes and other workers. All



participants were told about the child helpline and were asked to use it anytime. A new work plan was also planned in the workshop where it proposed to issue 'railway mitra' I-cards to people so that they may contact the railway department for any issues and help. All the members were issued 'R.P.F. Friend' identity card by the Team.

Case Study

A daily newspaper of Meerut reported that a girl was attempted to be murder as a sacrifice made by a tantrik. On 17th August, 2009, Meerut childline team reached the child's village and spoke with the child's family. They told them that the child was kidnapped while she was sleeping in the night on the 10th August 2009, at around 2 am in the night. As they didn't have any door in their house, all were sleeping in the open. The child told the team that the person who took her away was disabled with only one hand. He had stuffed the child's mouth with a cloth and took her to the nearby village's primary government school and tried to kill her by tying a rope to her neck. Due to this, the girl fainted. The tantric wrongly thought that the girl had died. He left the girl there and ran off into the night. After sometime the girl regained consciousness and returned to her village. There at her house, her mother found that she was missing from her bed. She asked the entire family about the child but no one had any clue of her whereabouts. They conducted a search for her in the neighboring areas but couldn't find her. By this time, the girl reached the village. Hearing a weeping sound, the family members located the child. The child told them about the bad incident which happened with her and then fainted. The family members took her to the local doctor. The girl regained consciousness after a whole three days. On 13 August, 2009, the parents of the child went to the police station for filing a FIR, but it was not registered by police. In between all this, the child's case was finalized by police and the village head(pradhan). As per the decision, the guilty side was asked to pay the money for the child's treatment and some compensation too. Meerut childline enquired with the police and village head (gram pradhan) about the case. They said that the child's father is a drunkard, so he is telling lies. Its all a made up story. Meerut child line team also tried to talk to the other villagers, but nobody was ready to divulge anything about the case. Even after child line tried to make the victim's father understand, he was not ready to take any legal action against the guilty party. Meerut child line reported the case to the Delhi Child Rights Commission and is awaiting a response.

The Janhit Family

Janhit Team

Anita Rana	Director
Ashinder Kaur	Honorary Advisor
Preeti Elhence	Coordinator
Sonakshi Hudda	P R Manager
Sandhya Verma	Administration Incharge
Priya Mittal	Documentation Officer
Devpal Singh	Sr. Programme Coordinator
Shiv Kumar	Sr. Programme Coordinator
Sunil Yadav	Programme Coordinator
Rohit Kumar	Programme Assistant
Ravindra Kumar	Programme Assistant
Ravindra Kumar Saini	Programme Assistant
Satyaveer Tyagi	Programme Assistant
Sita Ram	Programme Assistant
Jitendra Kumar	Programme Assistant
Santosh Hudda	Organic Aaharam Manager

CHILDLINE Team

Sanjiv Kumar	Coordinator	Manmohan Singh	Team Member
Asha Rani	Para-Professional	Pramod Kumar	Team Member
Ran Singh	Team Member	Anil Kumar	Team Member
Jyoti	Team Member	Kavita Sharma	Volunteer
Mahesh	Team Member	Anand Kumar	Volunteer
Satyendra Kumar	Team Member	Ghulam Mohammad	Volunteer

And the Team Says...

Sonakshi says "About CAF Project":

"We are very excited about this innovative project which is 'Spreading Water Literacy on Wheels in NOIDA District'. The project targeting schools of NOIDA, aims at raising awareness amongst school children on the qualities of drinking water and better water governance. As a part of the project we have already bought a 'Tata Winger' which is being designed along with attractive and informative literature that is being printed. Facilitated by Charities Aid Foundation, New Delhi and funded by Adobe Systems India Private Limited, through this three year project we will educate children about the importance of proper safe water conservation and so create a sustainable long-term solution to the growing problem of water crisis and water contamination in NOIDA district."

Sanjiv speaks on the "Independence Day":

"This celebration of Independence Day was really a special one. Getting to know these children was not new, but I think none of us had any idea about the tremendous potential they have in themselves until when we saw all of them performing with all their enthusiasm and energy. Youth in any form is the light for tomorrow. They just need the right guidance to their path. It was an wonderful experience."

Shiv Kumar about the "Mela":

"It was overall a very satisfying and encouraging experience for me. Although we had an idea of the many advantages of organic products and that they will be a popular product in the modern market; we were surprised at how eager people were to know more about these products. They actually readily took a sample to try them so that they can adopt them further in their lives. It was a good experience for both sides, promoting the organically grown crops and also encouraging farmers to adopt this methodology."

Kevin Mundy UK Volunteer.

"Seeing as this is the last newsletter that will be published by the foundation before I depart I wanted to write a few words. I would like to express my sincere thanks to Anita Rana for inviting me here to work alongside her and her team; it has proven to be a great opportunity for me. I have experienced a great deal in the workings of a grassroots NGO in India. I have learnt an enormous amount about the issues facing farmers in Uttar Pradesh, the problems caused by industrial and agricultural pollution, the situation regarding water and its growing scarcity as well as knowledge about the everyday struggle of poor and marginalised people here in India and the challenges they facing in securing their basic rights. I would like to thank all the staff at the foundation for making me feel so welcome and including me in their work, also teaching me about Indian culture and sharing with me the many festivals as well as personal family celebrations. I would like to also thank them for inviting me to their homes and showing me such wonderful hospitality. At times I have found living in Meerut very challenging and difficult, being so far away from my family and friends and my own culture has not always been easy but I am grateful for the support I have received from everyone here. This has been a fantastic opportunity for me and I have gained a great deal, I hope that this continues during my last few months here and that I have been able to provide worthwhile assistance to Janhit Foundation".